



CONFERENCE PROGRAM

The 40th Anniversary

Touchstone⁺

Conference

City on a Hill?

Christians in America at 250

Bradley J. Birzer

J. Budziszewski

Patrick Deneen

Rod Dreher

Carrie Gress

Adam J. MacLeod

Carl R. Trueman

Fr. Theophan Warren

C. R. Wiley

September 24–26, 2026

The DoubleTree Hotel by Hilton
Oak Brook, Illinois

www.thetouchstoneconference.com



The 40th Anniversary

Touchstone

Conference

Welcome to:

City on a Hill?

Christians in America at 250

The DoubleTree Hotel by Hilton, Oak Brook, Illinois
*All sessions will take place in the **GRAND BALLROOM**.*

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— All Saints Antiochian Orthodox Church —

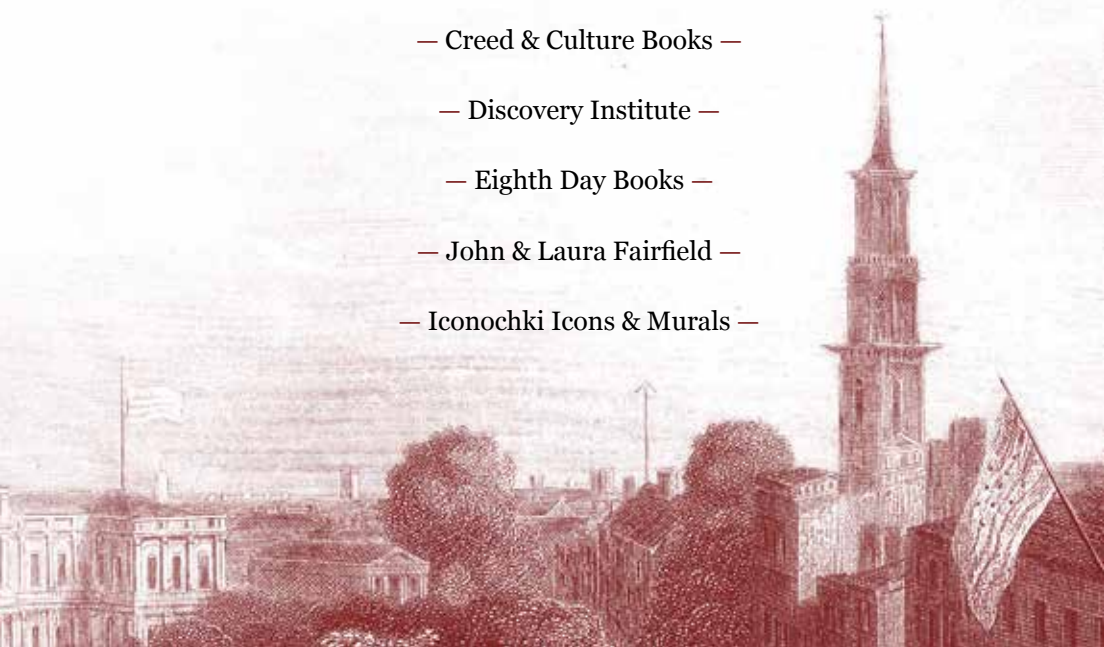
— Creed & Culture Books —

— Discovery Institute —

— Eighth Day Books —

— John & Laura Fairfield —

— Iconochki Icons & Murals —





SESSION I — THURSDAY EVENING

J. BUDZISZEWSKI

is Professor of Government, Philosophy, and Civic Leadership at the University of Texas at Austin, and the author of several books, including *Pandemic of Lunacy: How to Think Clearly When Everyone Around You Seems Crazy* (Creed & Culture, 2026).

FR. THEOPHAN

WARREN is an Orthodox priest serving at St. Seraphim Orthodox Cathedral in Dallas. He earned a Master of Theology degree from St. Tikhon's Orthodox Theological Seminary and has served in parish ministry for a number of years. He is a frequent preacher and teacher within the Orthodox tradition.

4:00 P.M. — REGISTRATION BEGINS

6:45 P.M.

J. DOUGLAS JOHNSON

Opening Remarks

7:00 P.M.

J. BUDZISZEWSKI

To Keep a Republic

Enlightened Self-Interest Is Not Enough

8:00 P.M.

FR. THEOPHAN WARREN

Testing the Spirits

Christian Discernment in an Age of Lawlessness

9:00 P.M. — RECEPTION

Please join us for refreshments and fellowship in the

RIVERVIEW BALLROOM.



SESSION II — FRIDAY MORNING

9:00 A.M.

CARL TRUEMAN

Land of Lost Content

*Reflections on England and
a Cultured Loss of Faith*

10:00 A.M. — BREAK

10:30 A.M.

PATRICK DENEEN

BRADLEY J. BIRZER

The Future of the
American Past

*An exchange hosted
by C. R. Wiley*

NOON — LUNCH

CARL TRUEMAN

is Professor of Biblical and Religious Studies at Grove City College. He is an esteemed church historian and a fellow at the Ethics and Public Policy Center. Dr. Trueman has authored or edited more than a dozen books, including *Strange New World* and *The Rise and Triumph of the Modern Self*. He is a contributing editor to *Touchstone*.

BRADLEY J.

BIRZER is Russell Amos Kirk Chair in American Studies and Professor of History, Hillsdale College. Author of several books, he is currently at work on a biography of sociologist and theorist Robert Nisbet.



SESSION III — FRIDAY AFTERNOON

PATRICK

DENEEN is

Professor of Political Science and holds the David A. Potenziani Memorial College Chair of Constitutional Studies at the University of Notre Dame. His books include *The Odyssey of Political Theory*, *Democratic Faith*, and *Why Liberalism Failed*.

C. R. WILEY is a senior editor at *Touchstone*, a co-host of *The Theology Pugcast* (a podcast with listeners in 60 countries), and a Presbyterian pastor serving a church in the Pacific Northwest. His most recent book is *Manmade: St. Anthony's Guide to Surviving the AI Apocalypse* (2026).

2:00 P.M.

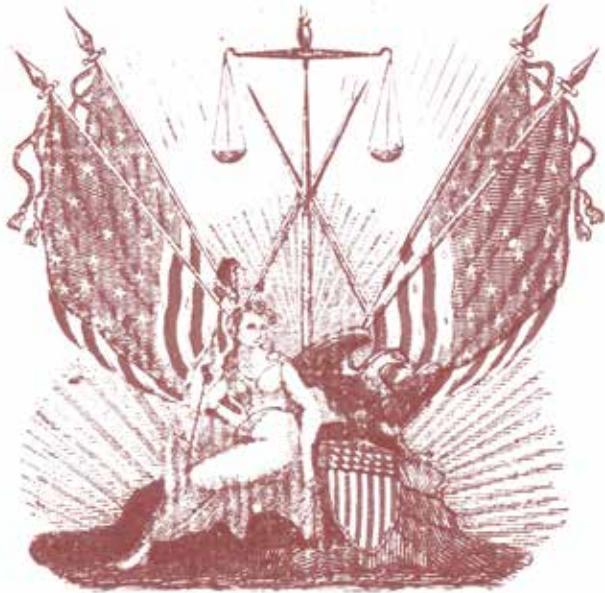
PANEL DISCUSSION

No Christianity, No Freedom

*Carl Trueman,
Patrick Deneen,
Rod Dreher
& C. R. Wiley*

3:20 P.M.

Break/Supper





SESSION IV — FRIDAY EVENING

7:30 P.M.

CARRIE GRESS

American Myth & Misery

*The True Story of Feminism's
“Liberated” Women*

• followed by Q & A

9:00 P.M. — **RECEPTION**

*Please join us for refreshments
and fellowship in the
RIVERVIEW BALLROOM.*

CARRIE GRESS

has a doctorate in philosophy from the Catholic University of America and is the editor at the online women's magazine *Theology of Home*. Her latest book *Something Wicked: Why Feminism Can't Be Fused with Christianity* was recently released with Sophia Institute Press.





SESSION V — SATURDAY MORNING

ADAM MACLEOD

is a Professor of Law and Co-Associate Dean for Faculty Research at The Catholic University of America, and a Fellow at the Center for Law and the Human Person. Dr. MacLeod is the author of four books, dozens of book chapters and scholarly articles, and more than one hundred essays and book reviews.

ROD DREHER is a journalist, author, and commentator on religion, culture, and politics. His books include *The Benedict Option* and *Live Not by Lies*. *Weimar America* will be published in 2027. He writes “Rod Dreher’s Diary” at Substack and a column for The Free Press. He is an Orthodox Christian living in Birmingham, Alabama.

9:00 A.M.

ADAM MACLEOD

American Renovation

The Common Law & the Light of Truth

10:00 A.M. — BREAK

10:30 A.M.

ROD DREHER

Weimar America

*Lessons from History for a
Post-Christian, Postmodern Nation*

11:30 A.M.

J. DOUGLAS JOHNSON

Closing Remarks



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— John & Laura Fairfield —

The 40th Anniversary *Touchstone* Conference

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— John & Carrie Colis —



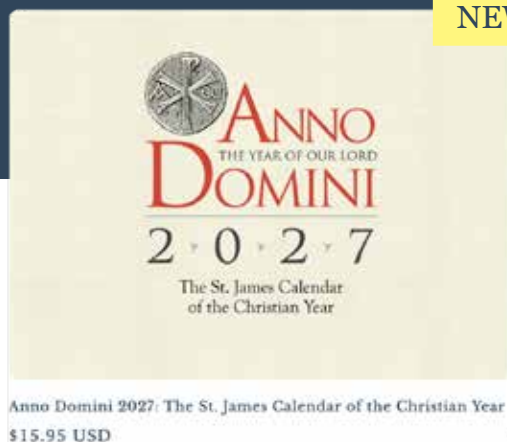
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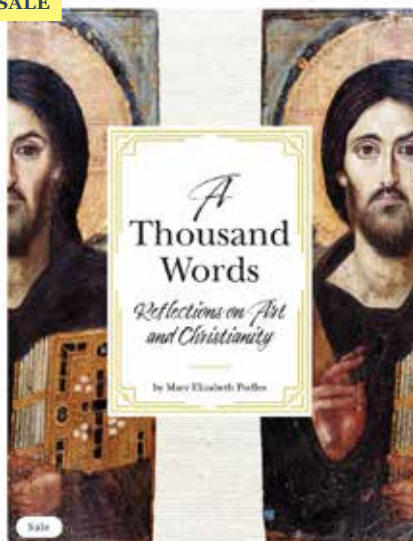


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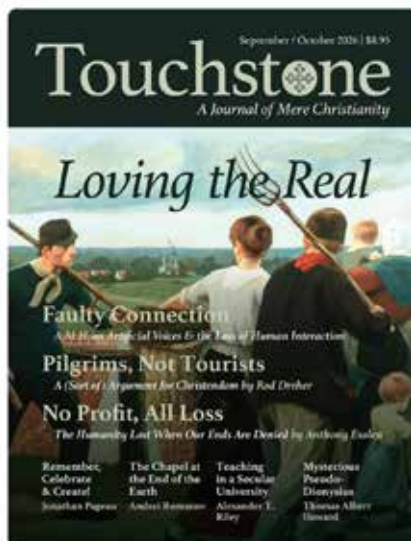


Anno Domini 2027: The St. James Calendar of the Christian Year
\$15.95 USD

SALE



A Thousand Words: Reflections on Art and Christianity
\$40.95 USD - \$39.95 USD



Touchstone September / October 2026
\$8.95 USD

SALE

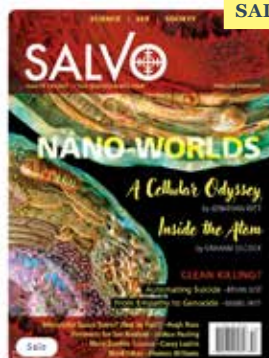


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Touchstone
GUILD

The earliest-known English guilds were not craft guilds but Christian confraternities formed to guard town walls and protect guild members. The Touchstone Guild is a small group of private donors who, through financial contributions of \$1,000 or more each year, make up our elite guard protecting everyone at *Touchstone* and the Fellowship of St. James.



Scan to join!

GUILD MEMBERS receive:

- *A Thousand Words: Reflections on Art and Christianity*
- *Anno Domini: The St. James Calendar of the Christian Year*
- Invitation to an annual meeting with our executive director
- Invitation to special events
- Recognition in the March/April issue of *Touchstone*

Touchstone WATCHMEN

For those who would like to give more but do not have the resources for Guild membership, we have established the Touchstone Watchmen. The Watchmen are donors who give \$500–\$999 a year.



Scan to join!

WATCHMEN receive:

- *Creed & Culture II: A Touchstone Reader*
- Invitation to special events
- Recognition in the March/April issue of *Touchstone*